

Travellers' Rest Hotel

Jeremiah Moloney of Yangery, second licensee of the *Travellers' Rest*, was granted a deed in January 1853 to 316a.1r.24p, which notice appeared in the *Government Gazette*. The land was situated on the eastern side of McVicar Street, Koroit, according to a map supplied by the Shire of Warrnambool.

During the 1850s the Chairman of the Licensing Court always remarked on how clean and tidy the hotel was kept. Many public auctions were held here by John McLeod, Macdonald and Lascelles and Craig and Macdonald for livestock in the big stockyards attached to the hotel. Working bullocks owned by Alexander Struth, Mr. McAllister, Joseph Smith and John Good were auctioned in May 1855. By 1856 Macdonald appeared to be in business with A. W. Lascelles, as they were noted as holding fortnightly sales every alternate Friday at the *Travellers Rest Inn*.

After the second ploughing match held on Mr. J. Jellie's property, *Wararook*, by the Villiers and Heytesbury Agricultural Association, a dinner took place at the hotel in August 1854 "which will no doubt be prepared after the well-known liberal style of mine hostess."

A feast of entertainment was offered at the *Travellers Rest* in November 1855 when Professor Bennett Clay advertised this extravaganza:

Positively for three nights only!!

Professor Bennett, the great wizard of the western parts, has the honor to announce his inimitable entertainment of scientific and fashionable Legerdemain at Maloney's Large Room at the Woodford hotel on Nov. 7, 8 and 9 1855 in addition to his Grand Optical Panorama. Admission 5s. Tickets may be had at the bar of the Hotel and of Professor Clay at Maloney's from 2-6pm daily. N.B. Every attention will be paid to secure etiquette and comfort to families attending this Entertainment.

The inquest into the death of Robert Smith Pink, who had been employed for a long time by Mr. Maloney, was held before Dr. Tierney and "a respectable jury" in January 1856. At the time of Pink's death he was employed by Messrs. Briggs, Napthine and Csillag of Woodford and the verdict reached was one of accidental

death. He had been "universally respected for his steadiness and honesty." He left a wife and child.

When the Warrnambool Road District was expanded, an election for the Board was held at the *Travellers Rest* in March 1856. The *Travellers Rest* also provided the venue for Board members to meet to discuss the formation of the Shire of Warrnambool in August 1862.

Whilst a continuation of names was not found between 1865 and 1868 it is highly likely that Daniel O'Grady carried on the business and either died or became too sick to take out the licence in 1869. The Warrnambool Licensing Court issued an extension of licence to Mrs. O'Grady in November 1869 and this was granted until December. A few weeks' later a public auction of household furniture, together with *Rob Roy* and other horses was conducted (as the hotel had been let, the Warrnambool newspaper remarked). Mrs. O'Grady invited tenders for the erection of a weatherboard house, with one chimney, to be used as a store, next to the *Travellers Rest* and by early 1870 was advertising:

Groceries, draperies and a large assortment of miscellaneous goods
always on hand. Dressmaking and mantlemaking done on the premises.

Mrs. O'Grady pursued her hotel interests and quite likely carried on as licensee after 1873, as the next notation lists the *Travellers Rest* for sale in July 1876, also

that piece of land between the hotel and the river and fronting the
Warrnambool Road containing 1a.2r.11p.

By November the mortgagee had stepped in to force the sale of

all that piece of land being part of portion 1, Yangery, on which is erected
a bluestone building known as the *Travellers Rest*.

Unfortunately neither the descriptions nor the names tie in with
maps of the area.

Travellers Rest Hotel - List of licensees:

11.05.49.

53. - 15.04.62.

J. M'Carthy - G - by Belfast Licensing Court
Jeremiah Moloney - L